



YOU ARE **20 WEEKS 3 DAYS**

137 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

The eyelids are still fused shut to protect your baby's developing eyes from prying fingers and toes. Deep within the brain, connections are starting to form to link the senses to those areas within the brain that are able to process information.

“Part of the fun of not knowing your baby's sex is anticipating what it might be, but be prepared for others to do the same.”

If you and your partner decided against finding out the sex of your baby at the 20-week scan, the guessing games will begin and you won't be short of people telling you what they think you're having. Perhaps your own instinct is the best of all: in one research study that asked pregnant women to guess the sex of their baby, 71 percent of the expectant moms surveyed guessed correctly.

SOME OLD WIVES' TALES

If you like testing a few old wives' tales on gender, consider these:

- **Ask someone to tie a gold ring** on to a piece of string and dangle it over your belly to “dowse” for the sex. If it swings from side to side or back and forth, it's a boy; if it spins around in a circular motion, you're having a girl.
- **Hairier than usual?** Apparently, according to the “old wives,” you're more likely to be carrying a boy.
- **If your baby's heart rate** is faster than 140 beats per minute, you're having a girl (but see [Heart rate and gender](#)).
- **Craving sugar, spice,** and all things sweet: girl. Sour or salty foods: boy.

ASK A MOM

I've found out at the 20-week scan that I'm having my third girl, but I so wanted a boy. How can I feel better about this? It can be enormously disappointing. I felt that I'd let my husband down in some way, especially since I knew he wanted a son.

By the time our daughter was born, we were both over the disappointment and were able to focus on being parents. If we'd waited until the birth to find out, it would have been hard to come to terms with it at the same time as trying to bond with our newborn baby.